

Derryk Whitner

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Security Operations Center Operator

Technical professional who specializes in solving complex, high-impact problems through structured investigation, evidence-based analysis, and systems thinking. Experienced in supporting mission-critical operations, investigating incidents, and improving the reliability of technical systems across operations, infrastructure, and software environments. Strongest where systems are complex, stakes are high, and answers require investigation rather than scripts. Known for a disciplined approach to root cause analysis, clear technical communication, and the demonstrated ability to translate complex technical analysis into practical, reliable solutions, with hands-on experience in cybersecurity, Linux, Python, AI-assisted automation, and software development.

SKILLS

Technologies: Docker, Git, Jira, Linux, OCR, Python, Streamlit, Windows

Core Competencies: Documentation, Incident Response, Log Analysis, Risk Assessment, Root Cause Analysis

Frameworks & Methods: Agile/Ticketing, CIA Triad, CIS Controls, NIST CSF, SOP Development

PROJECTS

AI Alcohol Label Verification System

Jun 2026 - Jun 2026

Python • Streamlit • OCR • Docker • Git

- Built an AI-assisted document verification application using OCR and rule-based validation to automate alcohol label reviews.
- Reduced processing time from 30+ seconds to under 5 seconds per label through iterative optimization.
- Developed batch uploads, CSV reporting, Docker deployment, and human-in-the-loop review workflows.

Cybersecurity Risk Assessment

Jun 2026 - Jun 2026

NIST CSF • CIS Controls • Risk Analysis • GitHub

- Performed a comprehensive enterprise cybersecurity assessment using the NIST Cybersecurity Framework and CIS Controls.
- Produced professional documentation, including a control matrix, CIA mapping, risk heat map, and executive audit report.
- Prioritized remediation recommendations based on business impact and risk severity.

Modular Software Architecture & Systems Integration

Nov 2024 - Present

Commercial Software Engineering Project (Unity/C#) • *Event-Driven Architecture* • *Git*

- Designed and engineered a modular, event-driven software architecture that integrates multiple third-party software components through custom transmitters, receivers, and bridge components without creating direct dependencies or modifying vendor code.
- Developed reusable integration layers that enabled independently developed systems—including AI, combat, vehicles, pedestrians, weather, and world streaming—to communicate seamlessly while remaining loosely coupled and independently replaceable.
- Investigated and resolved complex interactions across interconnected gameplay systems using structured debugging, root cause analysis, and iterative testing to improve stability, maintainability, and long-term scalability.
- Applied Git-based version control and iterative engineering practices throughout a multi-year commercial software project, culminating in a public Steam Store page and ongoing community playtest preparation.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Tesla • Austin TX

Systems Support Operations Engineer • Full-time

Feb 2024 - Aug 2025

- Investigated complex system and application incidents by analyzing logs, operational data, and diagnostic information to identify root causes, enabling engineering teams to implement corrective actions and improve system reliability.
- Utilized Linux command-line tools, SCP, and firmware management workflows to access production systems, validate deployments, and troubleshoot software and infrastructure issues in mission-critical environments.
- Recognized as the team's subject matter expert for outage investigations after developing a structured, evidence-based workflow that correlated monitoring alerts with Periscope telemetry, service records, and operational data to rapidly distinguish expected events from actionable incidents.
- Partnered with engineering teams to suppress recurring alert noise, trained four teammates on the investigation methodology, and helped improve team throughput from maintaining a weekly backlog to achieving daily completion.
- Leveraged Python-based tools, automation workflows, and AI-assisted analysis to reduce manual investigation effort, improve troubleshooting efficiency, and streamline technical documentation.

Strategic Service Solutions Inc. • Oakland, California, United States

Seaport Terminal IT Field Engineer

Sep 2021 - Feb 2022

- Installed, configured, and validated workstation hardware, storage devices, memory, and peripherals to support reliable deployment of production systems.
- Performed BIOS/UEFI configuration, firmware updates, and hardware validation to improve system stability, maintain compatibility, and support device lifecycle management.
- Diagnosed hardware, operating system, and network issues through structured troubleshooting and root cause analysis, restoring systems to operational readiness while minimizing downtime.

Acuitus, Inc. • San Francisco Bay Area

IT Program Systems and Networking Intern

Feb 2021 - Feb 2022

- Configured and administered Windows Server environments, including Active Directory, Domain Controllers, DHCP, DNS, File Services, and Exchange, to support secure and reliable enterprise network operations.
- Investigated and resolved Windows and Linux hardware and software issues while documenting configurations and technical findings to improve troubleshooting consistency and system reliability.

CERTIFICATIONS

LE-1: Linux Essentials

Feb 2024

Linux Professional Institute [mjause324g]

Google IT Automation with Python Specialization

Aug 2022

Coursera

Google IT Support Certificate

Oct 2021

Coursera

CompTIA A+

Jan 2024 - Jan 2027

CompTIA [RVSVRC6T1JQ418WS]

Artificial Intelligence Fundamentals

May 2026

IBM SkillsBuild

EDUCATION

Western Governors University • Bachelor of Science - BS in Cloud and Network Engineering

Jul 2026

Estimated Completion: 7/2028